

Framing Risk Choice Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Human Sciences • 20-30 min

Category	Human Sciences	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	framing-risk-choice

Big idea: The same evidence can lead to different choices when framed as gain or loss.

Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Framing Risk Choice Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Framing Risk Choice Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Gain frame: 200 of 600 people will be saved for sure, or a one-third chance all 600 are saved. Predict how people will respond, then identify the wording, context, incentive, or role that could change the result.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Framing Risk Choice Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Loss frame: 400 of 600 people will die for sure, or a one-third chance nobody dies. Predict how people will respond, then identify the wording, context, incentive, or role that could change the result.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Framing Risk Choice Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Loss frame: 400 of 600 people will die for sure, or a one-third chance nobody dies. Predict how people will respond, then identify the wording, context, incentive, or role that could change the result.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — The same evidence can lead to different choices when framed as gain or loss.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students
1	After inspecting Framing Risk Choice Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?
2	Which exact detail from Framing Risk Choice Stimulus A did you use as evidence?
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?
6	Are decisions based on evidence, framing, or both?

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Gain frame: 200 of 600 people will be saved for sure, or a one-third chance all 600 are saved.
- Loss frame: 400 of 600 people will die for sure, or a one-third chance nobody dies.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Human Sciences.

Activity Steps

1. Randomly give half the class a gain-framed version and half a loss-framed version.
2. Students choose between a certain option and a risky option.
3. Collect anonymous choices and compare class patterns by frame.
4. Reveal that the underlying outcomes were equivalent.
5. Debrief how framing can shape judgement without changing facts.

Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

What I noticed	What I inferred	Evidence	Confidence

TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: Are choices based on evidence, framing, or both?
- Can a rational decision be separated from how options are described?
- How do human scientists study hidden influences on judgement?

Knowledge Questions

- Are decisions based on evidence, framing, or both?
- How does language shape human judgement?
- What does experimental evidence reveal about rationality?

Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with the same option framed as lives saved versus lives lost. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...